

ICC RANKING: **1st**

BEST WC PERFORMANCE
CHAMPION (1978, 1982, 1988, 1997,
2005, 2013, 2022)

STRENGTHS

Australia remains the gold standard in the women's game, backed by depth across departments. Veterans like Ellyse Perry, Beth Mooney and Alyssa Healy are in form, while youngsters such as Phoebe Litchfield and Georgia Voll have slotted in seamlessly. With nine reliable bowling options, the squad carries an arsenal few can match. Their record underscores this supremacy: 24 matches in the current cycle, 18 wins and only three defeats.

WEAKNESSES

When opponents land early blows, Australia can lapse into passivity, as seen in India's rapid chase of 413 during the final ODI at the Arun Jaitley Stadium. Heavy reliance on matchup plans means that when those falter, the team appears unsettled, offering rivals a brief but exploitable opening.

OPPORTUNITIES

With at least 10 players from the triumphant 2022 campaign, experience is a clear asset. The younger group – Annabel Sutherland, Litchfield, Voll, Kim Garth – has shown the ability to shoulder high-pressure roles, giving the side both continuity and fresh energy.

THREATS

Alyssa Healy's reminder that "you can't defend a World Cup; you have to win it again" looms large. The third ODI against India highlighted that even Australia is not immune to batting collapses. From 378 for 5 in 44.2, it was bowled out for 412 in 47.5. Without Meg Lanning's tactical assurance, the team risks being reactive for longer spells, leaving strategic gaps for rivals to exploit.

PREDICTION

The most dominant ODI side of this cycle, Australia is a near-certain semifinalist. Stung by the T20 World Cup disappointment, the seven-time champion will chase redemption with trademark ruthlessness.

Lavanya Lakshmi Narayanan

COACH
SHELLEY NITSCHKE

CAPTAIN
ALYSSA HEALY



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